

Remote Work Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy outlines the expectations, responsibilities, and procedures for employees and consultants working remotely. It aims to ensure that remote work is carried out effectively, securely, and in a way that maintains productivity, communication, and collaboration across the organisation.

The organisation recognises the benefits of flexible working arrangements and supports remote work where appropriate, provided that business needs and performance standards are met.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, consultants, and contractors who are approved to work remotely, whether on a full-time, part-time, or occasional basis.

Remote work may include:

- working from home
- working from a temporary location
- working from a client site (where applicable)

All individuals working remotely must comply with this policy alongside all other relevant company policies.

3. Eligibility

Remote working arrangements are subject to approval by a line manager. Not all roles may be suitable for remote work, and decisions will depend on:

- the nature of the role
- operational requirements
- performance and reliability
- team collaboration needs

Approval may be granted on a permanent, temporary, or ad-hoc basis.

4. Working Hours and Availability

Employees working remotely are expected to maintain their agreed working hours and remain available during those times.

This includes:

- being reachable via company communication tools
- attending scheduled meetings
- responding to messages within a reasonable timeframe
- maintaining visibility and communication with the team

Employees must inform their manager in advance if they are unable to work or need to adjust their working hours.

5. Performance Expectations

Remote work does not change performance expectations. Employees are expected to:

- complete assigned tasks on time
- meet deadlines and objectives
- maintain the quality of their work
- communicate progress and any issues

Managers may monitor performance and provide feedback to ensure standards are maintained.

6. Communication and Collaboration

Effective communication is essential when working remotely. Employees must actively engage with their team and maintain regular contact.

This includes:

- participating in team meetings and updates
- using approved communication platforms
- sharing updates on tasks and progress
- asking for support when needed

A lack of communication may impact performance and team coordination.

7. Equipment and Technology

Employees are responsible for using company-provided equipment appropriately and ensuring that it is kept safe and in good condition.

Where company equipment is provided, employees must:

- use devices for authorised work purposes only
- report any faults or issues promptly
- not install unauthorised software
- ensure devices are secure at all times

If personal devices are used, they must meet company security requirements and be approved where necessary.

8. Data Security and Confidentiality

Remote work introduces additional security risks, and employees must take extra care to protect company and client data.

Employees must:

- access systems using approved secure methods
- avoid using public or unsecured networks without protection
- ensure screens are not visible to unauthorised individuals
- securely store and handle all documents and data

Confidential information must not be accessed, stored, or shared in ways that could compromise security.

9. Workspace Requirements

Employees are expected to maintain a suitable working environment when working remotely.

The workspace should:

- be quiet and free from unnecessary distractions
- allow for safe and comfortable working conditions
- support productivity and focus
- ensure confidentiality where required

Employees are responsible for ensuring that their remote working environment is appropriate for professional work.

10. Health and Wellbeing

The organisation recognises the importance of employee wellbeing when working remotely.

Employees are encouraged to:

- take regular breaks
- maintain a healthy work-life balance
- avoid excessive working hours
- communicate any concerns about workload or stress

Managers should support employees in maintaining wellbeing and monitor for signs of overwork or disengagement.

11. Attendance and Leave

Remote workers must follow the same procedures for attendance and leave as office-based employees.

This includes:

- submitting leave requests through the system
- notifying managers of sickness or absence
- not working during approved leave periods

Remote work should not be used as a substitute for leave where rest or time off is required.

12. Monitoring and Compliance

The organisation may monitor remote work activity where necessary to ensure compliance with policies, maintain security, and support performance management.

Monitoring will be carried out responsibly and in accordance with relevant laws and organisational procedures.

13. Issues and Support

Employees must report any issues that affect their ability to work remotely, including:

- technical problems
- connectivity issues
- equipment faults
- security concerns

Support should be requested through the appropriate IT or management channels.

14. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy may result in:

- review or removal of remote working arrangements
- performance management actions
- disciplinary action where appropriate

Remote work is a privilege that depends on maintaining standards and meeting expectations.

15. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure it remains effective and aligned with organisational needs.

Updates will be communicated to employees, and the latest version will be available through the company portal.